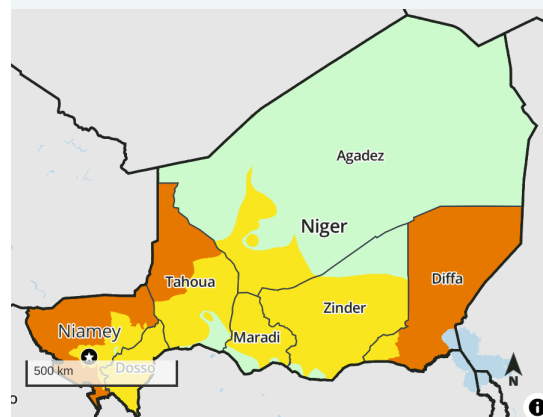


Insecurity continues to deteriorate in Tillabéry, Diffa, Tahoua, and Dosso regions

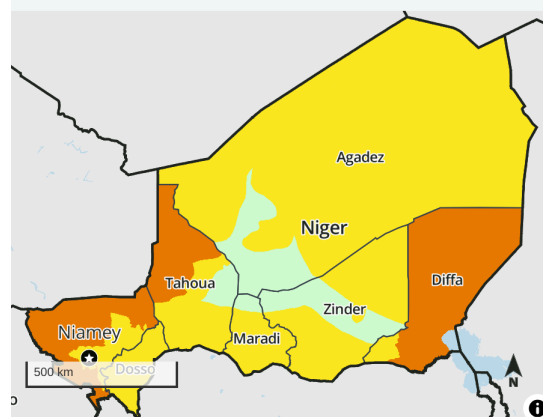
Key Messages

- Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes will likely persist in the regions of Tillabéry and Diffa, as well as in the northwestern part of Tahoua Region, from April through September 2026.** Conflict continues to cause population displacement and disrupt livelihoods and markets. Prices exceeding the purchasing capacity of displaced populations and poor host households are resulting in limited market access, and households are reducing meals to one or two per day due to lack of food stocks. The number of households in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) is expected to increase from June to September 2026, and around 5 percent could deteriorate into Emergency (IPC Phase 4) under the combined effects of conflict and flooding.
- Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are expected in agricultural, agropastoral, and pastoral areas not affected by conflict from May through September 2026.** Poor households' purchasing power is only sufficient to cover food expenditures, while food stocks are being depleted and households increasingly depend on markets characterized by very high food prices. Small groups of poor households with more severe food deficits are expected to deteriorate into Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes between June and September. Their limited purchasing power will only allow them to obtain very small quantities of food.
- The medium-term impacts of the conflict in the Middle East, driven by rising maritime freight costs and higher global oil prices, are expected to increase the prices of imported products and fertilizers.** However, in the short term, market prices have not yet been disrupted by the conflict. Niger's status as an oil-producing country and the diversity of supply sources for imported goods are helping to delay the transmission of ongoing disruptions to domestic markets for manufactured products.
- The security situation is deteriorating due to the increase and frequency of security incidents,** leading to population displacement and disruptions to markets and livelihoods. The main insecurity hotspots Tillabéry, Diffa, northwestern Tahoua, and Dosso.

Projected area-level acute food insecurity outcomes, April - May 2026



Projected area-level acute food insecurity outcomes, June - September 2026



IPC 3.1 acute food insecurity classification

Sub-national level data

1: Minimal	3: Crisis	5: Famine
2: Stressed	4: Emergency	

Symbols

! Would likely be at least one phase worse without current or planned humanitarian food assistance

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. For full disclosure, see endnotes.

Source: FEWS NET

This report provides an update to the [February to September 2026 Food Security Outlook](#) and [March 2026 Key Message Update](#). The analysis is based on information available as of April 22, 2026.



FEWS NET is a United States Government-funded activity. The content of this report does not necessarily reflect the view of the United States Government.

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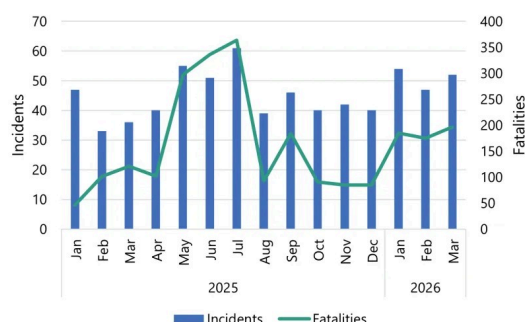
Current anomalies in food security conditions as of April 2026

- **The security situation in Niger continues to deteriorate, with increasing attacks by armed terrorist groups in the regions of Tillabéry, Diffa, Tahoua, and Dosso.** According to ACLED data, security incidents increased by 29 percent during the January-March 2026 period compared to the same period in 2025, with the largest increases recorded in Tahoua, Diffa, and Dosso (Figure 1). The analysis shows that terrorist attacks in 2026 caused an average of two fatalities per attack but were more deadly in the regions of Tahoua and Tillabéry, where the average reached three and four fatalities per attack, respectively.

Terrorist attacks continue to trigger forced population displacement. According to [UN High Commissioner for Refugees \(UNHCR\)](#) data, as of March 31, 2026, the country had 1,032,114 forcibly displaced people, including 548,386 internally displaced persons (IDPs), compared with 459,000 during the same period in 2025, representing an increase of 19 percent.

Figure 1

Number of security incidents and fatalities, January 2025 – March 2026



Source: ACLED

- **According to the final results of the 2025/26 agricultural season from the Ministry of Agriculture and Livestock, agricultural production declined by 10.7 percent compared with 2024/25, but remained similar to the five-year average.** The largest declines were observed in the regions of Agadez, Diffa, Tahoua, and Tillabéry, where losses in cultivated area and production were recorded due to conflict and flooding. In pastoral areas, the fodder balance indicates a decline of more than 23 percent compared to last year due to rainfall deficits. This fodder deficit, combined with limited access to some grazing areas, is leading to an early onset of the lean season in pastoral zones beginning in April 2026.
- **Markets are generally functioning normally overall, although major disruptions remain concentrated in markets located in conflict zones.** Food supplies are considered sufficient due to local supplies from surplus-producing farmers and traders, as well as government subsidized sales (82,000 metric tons of millet, sorghum, and maize). These subsidized sales, initiated in March 2026 by the Niger Food Products Office (OPVN), are expected to reach 820,000 households by the end of June 2026, or 1,435,000 people, in four phases. Demand is evolving steadily but remains lower than last year and below normal seasonal trends due to carryover stocks. Prices are generally lower than both last year's levels and the five-year average.
- **The continued influx of displaced people has led to an increase in labor supply, intensified competition, and below-average incomes.** Seasonal income-generating activities for poor and displaced households – such as agricultural labor for the maintenance and harvesting of off-season crops, as well as land preparation for the upcoming rainy season – are being further constrained by the reduction in cultivated areas caused by insecurity.

Updates to key assumptions about atypical food security conditions through September 2026

Most of the assumptions that underpinned FEWS NET's analysis of the most likely scenario for the [Niger Food Security Outlook from February to September 2026](#) remain valid; however, the following updates have been made to incorporate new evidence:

- **Food supply on markets will remain insufficient in conflict-affected areas.** In addition to the agricultural production deficit, which limits local supply, insecurity continues to disrupt roads and trade flows used to supply markets. However, stocks from the 2025/26 harvest, combined with carryover stocks and the continued government ban on cereal exports, are expected to ensure food availability countrywide, particularly in areas unaffected by conflict.

- **Poor households are expected to have low incomes due to the migration of populations from areas affected by agricultural deficits and increased competition in labor supply resulting from displacement from conflict areas.** Income-earning opportunities from seasonal agricultural labor will be insufficient relative to labor supply because displaced persons are competing alongside poor host households for the same opportunities.
- **Rainfall during the 2026/27 agricultural season is expected to be average to above average across Sahelian countries,** according to the latest weather forecast updates. However, with these anticipated heavy rains, flood risks are also expected to remain high across the different hydrological basins.
- **The conflict in the Middle East, with rising fuel and transport prices, is expected to increase fertilizer prices.** This will likely reduce fertilizer use and decrease the cultivated area dedicated to fertilizer-intensive crops. These reductions in cultivated areas are expected to lower agricultural production, reduce demand for agricultural labor, and depress seasonal wages for poor households.
- **The impacts of the ongoing conflict in the Middle East on global energy markets could lead food prices in Niger to rise above current projections,** especially if maritime trade disruptions and higher fuel prices persist. In a context of heavy dependence on imports through already constrained (Cotonou) and costly (Lomé) trade corridors, any increase in transport costs is likely to be quickly passed on to food prices. When combined with the lean season, during which households become increasingly market dependent, these factors could further intensify inflationary pressures.

Projected acute food insecurity outcomes through September 2026

Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected to persist in the regions of Tillabéry, Diffa, and northwestern Tahoua through September 2026. In these areas, poor households will deplete food stocks following very low agricultural production due to the combined effects of conflict and flooding. They will depend entirely on market purchases. Subsidized cereal sales generally contribute to stabilizing food prices in markets, but insecurity limits the geographic coverage of these operations. As a result, food price increases are expected to persist and worsen further due to the impacts of the conflict in the Middle East on transport costs and imported food products. These price increases are expected to reach their seasonal peak during this period, significantly restricting the purchasing power of poor and displaced households to very small quantities of food, insufficient to cover half of the required 2,100 kilocalories per person per day. Between June and September 2026, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are expected among a small proportion of poor displaced households (less than 5 percent) facing major livelihood disruptions due to theft and looting by armed terrorist groups and lacking income-earning opportunities in host areas.

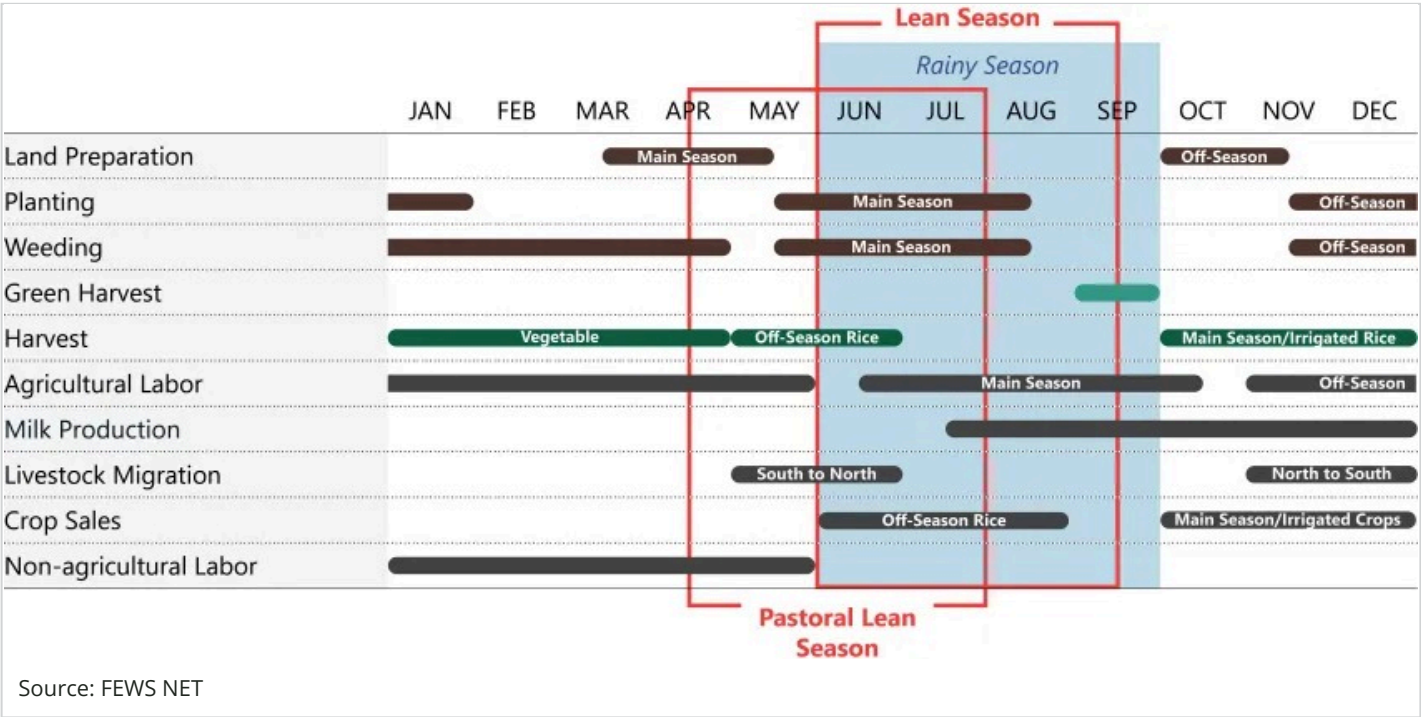
Agricultural, agropastoral, and pastoral areas unaffected by conflict are expected to face Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes from April through September 2026, with a small proportion of households in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) from June through September 2026. Poor households in these areas will deplete food stocks from own production and will rely on markets in a context of high prices and constrained purchasing power. However, substitution for cheaper food products will allow households to meet basic food needs. Food prices are expected to follow a sustained upward trend due to the effects of the lean season, progressively compounded by the impacts of the conflict in the Middle East, which are affecting fuel and imported food prices and transport costs. These disruptions will reduce the purchasing power of poor households in these areas from June through September 2026, limiting their expenditures primarily to food, while remaining insufficient to cover non-food needs. Small proportions of these poor households (around 5 percent) will lack sufficient food quantities, forcing households to reduce the number of meals or portion sizes, and causing gradual deterioration into Crisis (IPC Phase 3).

Annex 1: Updates to key sources of evidence used in this analysis

Many of the key sources of evidence utilized for FEWS NET's [February to September 2026 Food Security Outlook](#) remain the same; however, new and additional sources of evidence are listed below.

Evidence	Source	Data format	Food security element of analysis
Final results of the 2025/26 agricultural season	Ministry of Agriculture and Livestock	Quantitative	Total agricultural production compared to the previous year Rate of coverage of cereal requirements
Food assistance	Ministry of Trade/ government	Quantitative	Access to food assistance and its impact on meeting consumption needs
Evidence	Source	Data format	Food security element of analysis

Annex 2: Seasonal calendar



Recommended citation: FEWS NET. Niger Food Security Outlook Update April - September 2026: Insecurity continues to deteriorate in Tillabéry, Diffa, Tahoua, and Dosso regions, 2026.

* FEWS NET classification is **IPC**-compatible with limited exceptions. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. As of IPC 3.0, the IPC no longer assesses the impact of food assistance on classification and thus no longer maps the (!). However, FEWS NET continues to produce food security maps inclusive of the (!) as well as maps compatible with IPC 3.0/3.1, which include the mapping of food security assistance bags. In rare cases, FEWS NET classification is IPC-aligned but not IPC-compatible. IPC-aligned analysis is evidence-based but some types of evidence required for IPC-compatibility were not available.

Food Security Outlook Update

This Food Security Outlook Update provides an analysis of current acute food insecurity conditions and any changes to FEWS NET's latest projection of acute food insecurity outcomes in the specified geography over the next six months. Learn more [here](#).